

has to say about it: "Flow In Games has no real point. There is no score, and there doesn't seem to be an end. You control a deep-sea aquatic type creature and your mission is to eat stuff, gracefully and for as long as you can stand moving your mouse. For a game without goals, Flow In Games is incredibly addictive." Why we're talking about it is that it's been created by Jenova Chen and Kellee Santiago, two independent developers, who claim to be "tapping new emotions with their games." They're trying to give games the range of emotions that movies involve.

Chen says, "Right now, video games are focused on releasing anger and stress... that's really limited. If you want a deeper understanding of life, you aren't going to get it from a video game." Chen thinks games should get down to the business of "probing the light and dark sides of human emotion."

Along similar lines, Danny Ledonne, creator of the controversial *Super Columbine Massacre*—where

April, Come She Will

Vijay "The Wag" Padaya got hitched this month. Normally we would have ribbed him in this space a few months earlier, but he only told us after the deed was done. He just disappeared for a week—only Ed knew why, apparently—and returned sans sweets, bearing news and photographs of his nuptials. All of us are sorry for him, because as is the custom (which reflects life), the bride wears White and the groom wears Black.

April is the beginning of the new financial year, and naturally, we were all thinking about our own finances. (Read: the Annual Appraisal.) For the students amongst you, an appraisal is where the boss-man tells his boss-men how his team had performed in the past year (which he then

also conveys to us, the lesser employees). So there we were, each of us entering and then exiting Ed's office one by one, with either a smile or a frown gracing the face, depending upon whether Ed had smiled or frowned.

Asfaq (please don't pronounce it wrong) took the plunge and installed Ubuntu on his computer, so you guys can now send us more Linux questions. Actually, don't—the rest of us think he's recompiling his kernel more than he's working.

And finally, in anticipation of next month's "Sixth Sense" issue, many of us are sporting glassy-eyed looks—wondering whether we have a third eye, wondering whether we can do justice to the task. But we're sure we'll pull it off in the end.

DIGIT DIARY

players take on the roles of the Columbine shooters—says, "I do not believe the medium of interactive electronic media should be excluded from exploring the sorrows and challenges of the human experience."

The phrase "Emotions in games" sounds suspiciously like something meant for female gamers, but what Chen and Santiago and Ledonne are trying to say is current games hardly

encompass the spectrum of the life-experience that movies do. Sure, you have FPSs, strategy games, role-playing games, and more. FPSs, for example, provide outlets for emotions, primarily those of the violent kind. The others do involve creativity of some sort. But the point here is, do they imitate life?

In some ways, yes. But think of a movie like *American Beauty*, or *Requiem*

for a Dream, and you'll get the drift of what they're talking about. Many current games aim entirely to remove you from reality. Even simulation games put you in a *different* world. That might just change, if Chen and Santiago have gotten it right.

It's difficult to imagine what games of the future will be like, but think about the world of *Second Life* and you might get an idea. ■

Blog WATCH

A lot of people are talking about the Leopard release delay, but does it matter?

David Chartier doesn't like the idea that Apple first delays a release, then rushes on to release unfinished products.

David Chartier

<http://tinyurl.com/2bpv69>

Apple announces Leopard delays due to the iPhone

Apple has just issued a statement announcing that Mac OS X 10.5 Leopard has been delayed until October. The reason? iPhone: "we had to borrow some key software engineering and QA resources from our Mac OS X team, and as a result we will not be able to release Leopard at our Worldwide Developers Conference in early June as planned." However, Apple will still be displaying a "feature complete" version of Leopard at June's WWDC event, and will be giving beta versions for developers to take home and help put the finishing touches on.

This is a pretty significant announcement, especially considering that Apple has fallen under criticism for... shifting their focus from computers to consumer devices.

Is Leopard's delay causing any extent of technological difference to us?

Ilijtsch van Beijnum

<http://tinyurl.com/2blqsk>

Why the Leopard delay is a (somewhat) big deal

I always tell people that getting a Mac buys you much more than just a computing device. Since I joined the

club nearly four years ago, Apple's standard operating procedure has been fairly consistent: don't talk about plans, and release products when they're available, or at least ready to be ordered. This strategy has two important advantages: Apple gets to make a much bigger splash in the media when it has something new, and it avoids the Osbourne effect as much as possible, as customers keep buying the old products blissfully unaware that newer, better ones are on the way.

RSS is changing the rules of information distribution on the Web. What's the future?

Alex Iskold

<http://tinyurl.com/2x9upz>

The Future of RSS

...RSS usage has since spread beyond simple news delivery. Companies like de.licio.us, Flickr and YouTube added another dimension to RSS—i.e. they made it an integral part of the Social Web (social networking, photos, video, etc). Also, Google built Google Base, its Craigslist competitor, entirely on RSS. Other companies too are beginning to extend RSS, sometimes with proprietary extensions.

In short, because of RSS ubiquity it is now a very attractive delivery medium for all kinds of content. However because the basic format is simple and primitive, there is no way to encode semantics without building an extension...